Essay

2025 Supreme Court Wrap-Up

Final Rulings from the 2025 Term

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Final Rulings from the 2025 Term

Created by Author **The U.S. Supreme Court ended its term last Friday,** handing down rulings on **four major cases** that touch on the **balance of power, civil rights, education, and online access.**

(We planned to bring you this report the same day,

but a packed weekend pushed our wrap-up to Tuesday.)

Here's where the Court landed –

and where it left things undecided.

Trump v. CASA, Inc.

Issue: Can federal judges issue nationwide injunctions against executive orders?

Photo by Bermix Studio on Unsplash

This case was about the scope of judicial authority.

President **Trump issued an executive order seeking to end birthright citizenship** for the children of undocumented immigrants, and multiple **district courts blocked the policy** from taking effect–**nationwide.**

The **Trump** administration **challenged** this practice, **arguing that district judges should only grant relief to the specific plaintiffs** involved in each case, **not issue sweeping national rulings.**

1. Supporters of the administration saw this as a necessary check on judicial overreach.
2. Critics argued that limiting nationwide injunctions could let unconstitutional policies remain in effect until challenged in every jurisdiction–a high bar in practice.

The Court didn't rule on the constitutionality of Trump's order itself.

However, it did **narrow the power of lower courts to block presidential actions at a national scale.**

Majority Opinion

1. **Justice Amy Coney Barrett** wrote that universal injunctions "likely exceed the equitable authority that Congress has given to federal courts."

The decision limits relief to the actual plaintiffs, not the entire country.

Dissents

1. **Justice Jackson** warned the ruling is an "existential threat to the rule of law."
2. **Justice Sotomayor** called the decision "a travesty."

Read the full opinion (PDF)

Free Speech Coalition v. Paxton

Issue: Can states require age verification for access to adult websites?

Photo by appshunter.io on Unsplash

> The court weighed protecting minors online against preserving adult privacy rights.

In 2023, Texas passed a law requiring pornographic websites to verify users' ages before granting access.

The Free Speech Coalition challenged the law, arguing that it imposed unconstitutional burdens on speech and set a precedent for **intrusive state regulation of internet content.**

> **The Court sided with Texas, upholding the age verification requirement as a lawful means of protecting minors.**

Majority Opinion

1. **Justice Clarence Thomas** found the law *"appropriately tailored"* and not overly burdensome on adult speech.

Dissents

1. **Justice Kagan** argued the law infringes on privacy and sets a worrying precedent.
2. She noted that *lawful adult access to content should not require identity disclosure.*

Read the full opinion (PDF)

Mahmoud v. Taylor

Issue: Are public schools required to allow religious opt-outs from LGBTQ+ content?

Photo by National Cancer Institute on Unsplash

> This case tested how far public schools must go in accommodating religious beliefs in the classroom.

A group of parents in Maryland sued after being denied the ability to opt their children out of readings and lessons involving LGBTQ+ topics.

The families argued the curriculum conflicted with their religious beliefs and that the denial violated their First Amendment rights.

> **The Court agreed,** ruling that **schools must allow opt-outs** when there are "deeply held religious objections."

Supporters of the decision viewed it as a win for religious liberty, while critics warned it undermines inclusive education and opens the door to curriculum patchwork.

The ruling could have far-reaching effects on how schools handle controversial or sensitive content.

Majority Opinion

1. **Justice Alito** held that denying opt-outs imposes a burden on religious exercise.
2. The ruling emphasized **accommodation for religious objections.**

Dissents

1. **Justice Sotomayor** warned the **decision threatens educational equity** and consistency.
2. Dissenters argued that public curricula should be applied equally to all.

Read the full opinion (PDF)

Callais v. Louisiana

Issue: Must Louisiana redraw its congressional map to include a second majority-Black district?

Photo by Element5 Digital on Unsplash

> This redistricting case had the potential to reshape Louisiana's congressional delegation–and to clarify the reach of the Voting Rights Act.

At issue was **whether Louisiana's current map unfairly diluted Black voting power** by failing to include a second majority-Black district.

Civil rights groups sued, arguing that the map violated federal law.

> Instead of resolving the question,

> The Supreme Court chose to defer.

The case has been **postponed until next term**, leaving the challenged map in place for now.

The decision frustrated voting rights advocates, who say delays continue to disenfranchise voters.

Justice Thomas*, in dissent,* criticized the Court for avoiding a decision with immediate consequences.

Notes

1. **The case was deferred** until the next term–**no final ruling** was issued.
2. The current redistricting map remains in place.

Read the full opinion (PDF)

Conclusion

What These Rulings Mean Going Forward

Photo by Tingey Injury Law Firm on Unsplash

Each of these cases adjusts how law is practiced and interpreted across different parts of American life.

In *Trump v. CASA*, the Court restricted the use of nationwide injunctions. This **shifts more responsibility to Congress to clarify judicial powers** and may result in slower national responses to contested executive actions.

In *Free Speech Coalition v. Paxton*, the ruling **reinforces states' ability to impose content restrictions in the name of protecting minors.**

The decision is likely to influence how states approach internet regulation.

The ***Mahmoud v. Taylor*** decision **extends First Amendment protections for religious parents in public schools.**

School districts may need to revise opt-out policies to comply.

In *Callais v. Louisiana*, the Court's deferral leaves **unresolved questions about racial representation in redistricting.**

The case will return next term; **Louisiana's current map remains** in use.

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No spin.

Just facts.

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